

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1995-12-26

To the conference of the continental boards of cou

1 with great happiness we welcome you to this momentous conference,
2 which is graced by the presence of three hands of the cause of god. it
3 marks the opening of a period of intense activity as the twentieth century, hailed by
'Abdu'l-b ahá as "a century of life and renewal,"
4 210-1 draws to a
5 close, and a new century of enormous challenge for all mankind opens be-
6 fore us. To guide the activities of the bahá'í world during this period, we
7 have decided to launch a four year plan at riḥvân 1996. The provisions of
8 that p lan are to be the focus of your consultations in the coming six days.
9 The continental boards of counselors have been an integral part of the
10 Administrative order for over twenty-five years. your institution has made
11 an essential contribution to the strengthening and evolution of the bahá'í
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211 1993–1996 • T h e Th r e e Ye a r Pl a n
212 59community, and your role in the protection and growth of the cause will
213 be of even greater consequence in the years ahead.
214 if there is any question of the speed with which history is unfolding,
215 we need but recall the events, both within and without the bahá'í commu-
216 nity, which have transpired since the counselors assembled in conference
217 in 1985. The transformations of this remarkable first decade of the fourth
218 epoch of the formative Age of the faith, seen in the light of the promises
219 in our Sacred Scriptures, throw into sharp perspective the great range of the

220 tasks before us. can we have any doubt that events will henceforth move at
221 a still more rapid pace and will change the world even more radically than
222 have those of the past decade?
223 At this crucial point in the fortunes of humankind, your role and that
224 of your Auxiliaries in calling forth the wholehearted endeavors of the fol-lowers of
bahá'u'lláh, in raising the level of their spiritual awareness, and
225 in promoting the evolution of national and local bahá'í institutions is of
226 fundamental importance. in that realization we eagerly anticipate the fruits
227 of your deliberations during the coming days. we shall offer fervent prayers
228 at the Sacred Threshold that the confirmations of the Almighty will guide
229 and reinforce your services both now and through the years to come.
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Publication of a Persian Edition of the Kitáb-i-Aqdas

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]